EQUINOX FRONTIER MARKETS WEEKLY

INSTITUTIONAL MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Nigeria

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- Doubts over AI returns drove a ▼6.72% Thursday rout in US chip stocks, leaving the S&P 500 ▼0.47% WoW at 7,623.68, while Brent jumped ▲6.6% to $117.14 on Houthi strikes against Saudi infrastructure.
- The NGX ASI eased ▼0.13% to 247,222.27, trimming YTD gains to ▲58.87%, on 2.02bn shares worth ₦110.77bn, and held up best in Africa as every regional bourse fell, led by JSE ▼2.63%.
- Industrial Goods was the only gaining sector at ▲1.95% as Dangote Cement hit its ▲10.00% limit on Friday, Insurance fell ▼2.79%, ABC Transport ▲20.66% led gainers and UPDC REIT ▼17.26% led losers.
- The naira weakened ▼2.2% WoW to ₦1,361.84 despite record $1.01bn NFEM turnover, while September CPI eased to 14.63% against a 23.00% MPR and reserves rose to $55.16bn.
- With decliners outnumbering advancers 55 to 20, next week's tests are the 27 Oct Dangote refinery IPO close, the ₦800bn NTB auction and FOMC decision on 28 Oct, and MTN's Q3 board meeting on 29 Oct.

Market Outlook — Coming Week

- **Market performance became more concentrated in large caps as overall breadth weakened.**
  - Breadth: on NGX's weekly count, the advance/decline ratio fell to 0.36x from 1.67x, with 55 decliners against 20 advancers and 71 of 146 securities unchanged.
  - Concentration: on official NGX capitalisations, the ten watch list stocks gained ₦0.60tn (▲0.59%) while the whole market shed ₦206bn, so the remaining stocks lost approximately ₦0.81tn in aggregate. Dangote Cement's ₦0.75tn gain alone exceeded the group's net rise.
  - Index level: NGX 30 held at ▼0.01% against ▼0.77% for the Main Board Index. The ASI sits 2.1% below its 252,635.11 52 week high, so the pullback is shallow but increasingly concentrated.
- **Liquidity is being pulled in competing directions**.
  - Activity: value traded rose ▲12.9% to ₦110.77bn and volume ▲22.0% to 2.02bn shares, while deals fell ▼6.2% to 173,113, lifting average deal size ▲20.4% to about ₦639,900. This indicates a shift towards larger average transactions, although the available data do not identify investor type.
  - CBN: it sold ₦2.63tn of OMO bills on 22 Oct against a ₦2.00tn offer, at stop rates of 17.14% on the 180 day bill and 17.63% on the 138 day bill.

- Dangote refinery offer: the ₦2.15tn offer closes 27 Oct, and the basis of allotment is not due at the SEC until 10 Nov. Refund timing may therefore delay the return of unallotted funds, although subscribers can draw on other liquidity in the meantime.
- NTB auction: the ₦800bn offer on 28 Oct follows a 14 Oct auction where the 364 day stop rose to 15.90% and only ₦269.06bn of ₦450bn was allotted.

➢ **The equity to bond yield gap remains wide, while reported bank earnings provide a near term test of current valuations.**

- Earnings yield gap: at 18.83x, the covered Main Board universe excluding constituents above 100x (51 of 125 lines) offers a 5.31% earnings yield against an FGN 10Y yield of 16.90%, a gap of 11.59pp, little changed from 11.66pp. This is a substantial relative yield disadvantage for equities rather than a self-contained valuation signal, since it does not capture earnings growth, dividends or currency risk.
- Banking: the sector trades at 21.93x on equal weighted averages, with Zenith at 9.1x and Access at 9.4x against 61.9x for First HoldCo. 9M results from First HoldCo (PAT ▲65.11%) and Stanbic IBTC (▲33.00%) have yet to enter trailing multiples, but falling net interest income at both (▼16.02% and ▼14.93%) leaves the persistence of that growth open.
- Fidelity: H1 2026 audited accounts remain outstanding with no date.

➢ **Four risks could extend the pullback: FX, earnings, global rates and oil**.

- **FX**: the official to parallel spread narrowed to ₦13.16 only because the official rate weakened ▼2.2% to ₦1,361.84. A move through ₦1,370 despite CBN sales and $55.16bn of reserves would signal persistent demand pressure and weigh on foreign returns.
- **Earnings**: Dangote Cement's board meets on 27 Oct to consider Q3 accounts; its 1,766.5x printed P/E offers no valuation anchor for Industrial Goods' ▲87.56% YTD run. MTN Nigeria and BUA Foods boards meet on 29 Oct. BUA Cement's board met on 20 Oct, but no 9M release had appeared as at 26 Oct.
- **Global rates**: the Fed decides on 28 Oct with the US 10Y at 4.9986%. A hawkish outcome or a renewed AI selloff would dent frontier risk appetite.
- **Oil and inflation**: Brent above $117 may support FX inflows, but higher oil prices could also raise domestic fuel costs ahead of October CPI and the 23 and 24 Nov MPC. The net effect will depend on oil receipts, domestic pricing and pass-through to inflation.

SECTION 1 | GLOBAL MARKETS SNAPSHOT

Index / Market	This Week Close	WoW %	MoM %	YTD %	52-Wk High	52-Wk Low
S&P 500 (USA)	7,623.68	-0.47%	-0.36%	+11.16%	7,844.52	6,316.91
STOXX 600 (Europe)	635.77	-1.39%	+0.14%	+6.65%	663.41	556.96
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	62,693.16	-4.03%	-6.08%	+20.95%	72,831.73	48,235.30
Shanghai Comp. (China)	3,690.48	-0.69%	-3.95%	-8.28%	4,258.86	3,574.27
KOSPI (South Korea)	5,550.30	-2.08%	-18.83%	+28.79%	9,385.59	3,822.33

Global Markets Commentary

- AI skepticism set the tone. S&P 500 closed ▼0.47% WoW at 7,623.68. Thursday's ▼2.60% Nasdaq slide, its steepest since June, and a ▼6.72% SOX rout followed Tesla and Meta results that left AI return questions unanswered.
- Asia absorbed the heaviest losses. Nikkei 225 fell ▼4.03% WoW and KOSPI ▼2.08%, extending a ▼18.83% MoM slide that leaves it 41% below its 9,385.59 52 week high. Shanghai Comp. is ▼8.28% YTD.
- Energy reignited inflation risk. Brent rose ▲6.6% WoW to $117.14 on Houthi strikes against Saudi infrastructure. Spot gold fell ▼4.0% to $3,996.83, below $4,000, as rate hike bets firmed. The flight to quality pulled the US 10Y yield under 5%, to 4.9986%.
- Europe added a sovereign stress layer. STOXX 600 fell ▼1.39% WoW as a French bond selloff pushed the country's risk premium to its highest since 2011, with a Moody's review pending. EUR/USD slipped to $1.1193. Next week brings the FOMC and Alphabet, Microsoft and Amazon earnings.

SECTION 2 | FRONTIER AFRICA MARKETS SCOREBOARD

Market / Index	Index Level	WoW %	1M %	YTD %	Mkt Cap
Nigeria — NGX ASI	247,222.27	-0.13%	-1.58%	+58.87%	₦160.52 tn
South Africa — JSE All Share	108,020.14	-2.63%	-3.18%	-6.74%	R24.54 tn
Kenya — NSE All Share	234.92	-1.72%	-4.97%	+25.91%	Ksh3.94 tn
Egypt — EGX 30	51,052.26	-2.34%	-1.62%	+24.83%	EGP3.78 tn
Ghana — GSE Composite	14,111.00	-1.97%	-1.23%	+60.86%	GHS266.72 bn

African FX Snapshot

Currency Pair	Rate (Fri Close)	WoW Chg	WoW %	YTD %	As-of Date
USD/NGN (Nigeria Official)	1,361.84	29.58	+2.22%	-5.85%	2026-10-23
USD/ZAR (South Africa)	16.59	0.10	+0.63%	+0.49%	2026-10-23
USD/KES (Kenya)	129.85	1.01	+0.78%	+1.45%	2026-10-23
USD/EGP (Egypt)	55.30	1.90	+3.56%	+15.95%	2026-10-23
USD/GHS (Ghana)	11.60	0.32	+2.80%	+6.42%	2026-10-23
USD/NGN Parallel (Bureau)	1,375.00	-5.00	-0.36%	-7.41%	2026-10-23

FX tables are quoted on the currency-pair convention: a negative figure denotes a fall in USD/NGN, that is, naira appreciation. Narrative commentary describes moves in the local currency, so a rise in the pair is reported as local currency weakness. USD returns are computed as (1 + local YTD return) ÷ (1 + YTD change in USD/local) − 1, using the pair returns shown.

Frontier Africa Commentary

- Global risk off pulled every African bourse lower WoW. NGX ASI held up best at ▼0.13% to 247,222.27. JSE All Share fell hardest at ▼2.63%, alongside the developed market selloff in Section 1 and spot gold's ▼4.0% weekly slide.
- Nigeria leads once returns are converted to dollars. Ghana's GSE Composite tops local YTD returns at ▲60.86%, but in USD NGX ASI returns ▲68.7% against ▲51.2% for Ghana. JSE is the only YTD loser, ▼6.74% local and ▼7.2% in USD.
- The Egyptian pound was the weakest currency. USD/EGP rose ▲3.56% WoW to 55.30, followed by USD/GHS ▲2.80% to 11.60 and USD/NGN ▲2.22% to ₦1,361.84. The naira's official rate closed ₦13.16 (1.0%) below the ₦1,375.00 parallel rate.
- Currency translation is the dominant return driver. Egypt's ▲24.83% local YTD gain shrinks to ▲7.7% in USD after a ▲15.95% rise in USD/EGP. A ▼5.85% YTD fall in USD/NGN lifts Nigeria's dollar return to ▲68.7%.

SECTION 3 | NIGERIA — MARKET PULSE

NGX ASI Level	Weekly Change	YTD Return	Market Cap (₦tn)
247,222.27	**-0.13%**	**+58.87%**	**₦160.52tn**

Weekly Volume (bn)	Turnover (₦bn)	Advances	Declines
2.02bn	**₦110.77bn**	**20**	**55**

Unchanged	A/D Ratio	Number of Deals	52-Wk ASI Closing Range
71	**0.36x**	**173,113**	**141,327.30–252,635.11**

Market Snapshot Commentary

- The NGX ASI eased ▼0.13% WoW to 247,222.27, its fourth consecutive weekly decline after ▼0.33% the prior week, trimming the YTD return to ▲58.87% from ▲59.07%. Market capitalisation fell ₦206bn to ₦160.52tn. The index fell ▼0.91% on Monday, when Dangote Cement dropped ▼5.50%, reached a weekly low of 244,956.94 on Thursday and recovered ▲0.92% on Friday as Dangote Cement and First HoldCo hit their ▲10.00% daily limits.
- Activity rose while prices fell. Value traded rose ▲12.93% WoW to ₦110.77bn and volume ▲22.0% to 2.02bn shares, with Friday alone accounting for 611.66m shares. Deals fell ▼6.2% to 173,113, lifting average deal size ▲20.4% to about ₦639,900, which indicates larger average transactions, although the data do not identify investor type. Breadth deteriorated sharply: on NGX's weekly count, 20 stocks advanced, 55 declined and 71 were unchanged, cutting the advance/decline ratio to 0.36x from 1.67x.
- The ASI sits 2.1% below its 52 week closing high of 252,635.11 (28 Sep) and 74.9% above its 141,327.30 low. The NGX Premium Index rose ▲0.80% while the Main Board Index fell ▼0.77%, consistent with heavier weighted names cushioning the headline as breadth weakened.

SECTION 4 | NIGERIA — SECTORAL SCOREBOARD

Index / Sector	This Week Close	Prior Week Close	WoW %	MTD %	YTD %	QTD %
NGX All-Share Index (ASI)	247,222.27	247,539.73	-0.13%	-1.59%	58.87%	-1.59%
NGX Main Board Index	10,721.06	10,804.60	-0.77%	-1.37%	42.39%	-1.37%
NGX 30 Index	9,100.27	9,101.27	-0.01%	-1.53%	60.42%	-1.53%
NGX Banking Index	2,515.47	2,532.47	-0.67%	-7.25%	65.94%	-7.25%
NGX Consumer Goods Index	4,014.81	4,036.97	-0.55%	-1.07%	0.99%	-1.07%
NGX Oil & Gas Index	6,035.77	6,194.00	-2.55%	-3.38%	126.04%	-3.38%
NGX Industrial Goods Index	10,646.68	10,442.95	1.95%	1.98%	87.56%	1.98%
NGX Insurance Index	1,049.43	1,079.57	-2.79%	-3.47%	-11.76%	-3.47%
NGX Pension Index	12,804.21	12,895.45	-0.71%	-3.76%	79.88%	-3.76%
NGX Sovereign Bond Index	661.50	661.50	0.00%	-0.03%	-3.03%	-0.03%

Market Snapshot Commentary

- NGX Industrial Goods led at ▲1.95% WoW to 10,646.68, the only sector gainer, driven by Dangote Cement. The stock fell ▼5.50% to ₦1,008.00 on Monday, then hit its ▲10.00% daily limit at ₦1,111.00 on Friday, a ▲4.15% net weekly gain. Insurance lagged at ▼2.79% to 1,049.43, deepening its YTD loss to ▼11.76%.
- Selling was broad and stock specific, led by Consolidated Hallmark ▼7.14%, International Energy Insurance ▼6.48% and Linkage ▼6.29% in single sessions. Oil & Gas fell ▼2.55% despite Brent's ▲6.6% weekly rise; the index fell ▼2.51% on Friday, the session in which Aradel dropped ▼6.33%.
- Banking eased ▼0.67%, recovering from its Thursday low of 2,452.40 on Friday gains in First HoldCo ▲10.00% and Fidelity ▲9.09%. Next week, watch whether Friday's rally in cement and large banks broadens, given 55 decliners against 20 advancers this week.

SECTION 5 | NIGERIA — TOP MOVERS

▲ Top Gainers

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Prior Close (₦)	Change (₦)
1	ABCTRANS	ABC TRANSPORT PLC	7.30	+20.66%	6.05	+1.25
2	AVACAP	AVA CAPITAL PLC	7.30	+17.74%	6.20	+1.10
3	CAVERTON	CAVERTON OFFSHORE SUPPORT GRP PLC	4.80	+17.07%	4.10	+0.70
4	FIDELITYBK	FIDELITY BANK PLC	24.00	+14.01%	21.05	+2.95
5	MULTITREX	MULTI-TREX INTEGRATED FOODS PLC	0.66	+10.00%	0.60	+0.06
6	LIVINGTRUST	LIVINGTRUST MORTGAGE BANK PLC	3.22	+9.90%	2.93	+0.29
7	MEYER	MEYER PLC	17.50	+9.72%	15.95	+1.55
8	CMFC	CRITICAL MINERALS FINANCING CORP PLC	3.57	+7.85%	3.31	+0.26
9	THOMASWY	THOMAS WYATT NIGERIA PLC	2.60	+7.44%	2.42	+0.18
10	NASCON	NASCON ALLIED INDUSTRIES PLC	183.50	+7.31%	171.00	+12.50

▼ Top 10 Losers

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Prior Close (₦)	Change (₦)
1	UPDCREIT	UPDC REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT TRUST	17.50	-17.26%	21.15	-3.65
2	OMATEK	OMATEK VENTURES PLC	1.40	-12.50%	1.60	-0.20
3	UPL	UNIVERSITY PRESS PLC	4.35	-12.12%	4.95	-0.60
4	REGALINS	REGENCY ALLIANCE INSURANCE PLC	0.71	-11.25%	0.80	-0.09
5	NGXGROUP	NIGERIAN EXCHANGE GROUP PLC	152.50	-10.29%	170.00	-17.50
6	LIVESTOCK	LIVESTOCK FEEDS PLC	17.05	-10.26%	19.00	-1.95
7	VITAFOAM	VITAFOAM NIGERIA PLC	174.60	-10.00%	194.00	-19.40
8	CWG	CWG PLC	18.05	-9.98%	20.05	-2.00
9	INTBREW	INTERNATIONAL BREWERIES PLC	9.05	-9.50%	10.00	-0.95
10	TRIPPLEG	TRIPPLE GEE AND COMPANY PLC	2.82	-8.74%	3.09	-0.27

Source: NGX weekly market report for the week ended 23 Oct 2026. Equities only; closes are Friday 23 Oct against Friday 16 Oct. Returns are price returns.

Most Active by Volume (Mon 19 to Thu 22 Oct)

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	ZENITHBANK	ZENITH BANK PLC	121.50	-3.57%	116,853,455	14,298,438,253
2	UBA	UNITED BANK FOR AFRICA PLC	41.80	-2.79%	94,175,116	3,952,020,811
3	ACCESSCORP	ACCESS HOLDINGS PLC	26.75	-6.14%	89,027,827	2,391,089,323
4	LIVESTOCK	LIVESTOCK FEEDS PLC	18.90	-0.53%	82,536,263	1,546,692,114
5	GTCO	GUARANTY TRUST HOLDING COMPANY PLC	122.00	-2.24%	65,350,611	8,000,794,445

Most Active by Value (Mon 19 to Thu 22 Oct)

#	Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	WoW %	Weekly Vol	Value Traded (₦)
1	ARADEL	ARADEL HOLDINGS PLC	1,499.90	0.00%	12,105,647	18,157,259,935
2	ZENITHBANK	ZENITH BANK PLC	121.50	-3.57%	116,853,455	14,298,438,253

3	GTCO	GUARANTY TRUST HOLDING COMPANY PLC	122.00	-2.24%	65,350,611	8,000,794,445
4	MTNN	MTN NIGERIA COMMUNICATIONS PLC	825.00	0.00%	9,331,872	7,698,794,400
5	FIRSTHOLDCO	FIRST HOLDCO PLC	131.00	-5.07%	39,199,795	5,268,809,986

Most active tables cover Monday 19 to Thursday 22 Oct from the per-ticker data, with closes on Thursday 22 Oct against Friday 16 Oct; Friday's session is not included. For the full week, NGX reports Multi-Trex Integrated Foods, Zenith Bank and Livestock Feeds as the three most traded stocks by volume, at 521.57m shares worth ₦19.09bn combined. Friday's largest values traded were Aradel (₦4.20bn), Stanbic IBTC (₦3.17bn), Dangote Cement (₦2.85bn), Zenith Bank (₦2.24bn) and GTCO (₦2.04bn).

Market Movers Commentary

- NGX Group fell ▼10.29% to ₦152.50 even as market value traded rose ▲12.93% WoW, a divergence for an exchange operator whose earnings track turnover; its 9M results, published on 24 Oct after the decline, showed PAT ▲86.44% to ₦14.69bn. Fidelity Bank rose ▲14.01% to ₦24.00, including ▲9.09% on Friday, while its H1 2026 audited accounts remain outstanding. Aradel led Monday to Thursday value at ₦18.16bn with an unchanged price, then fell ▼6.33% to ₦1,405.00 on Friday on a further ₦4.20bn traded; the concentration is consistent with large transactions, although trade level data are not available. ABC Transport's ▲20.66% gain came on about ₦45m of value and coincided with the board's ₦6.5bn capital raise approval disclosed on 21 Oct, so the signal is weak.

Large-Cap Watch List

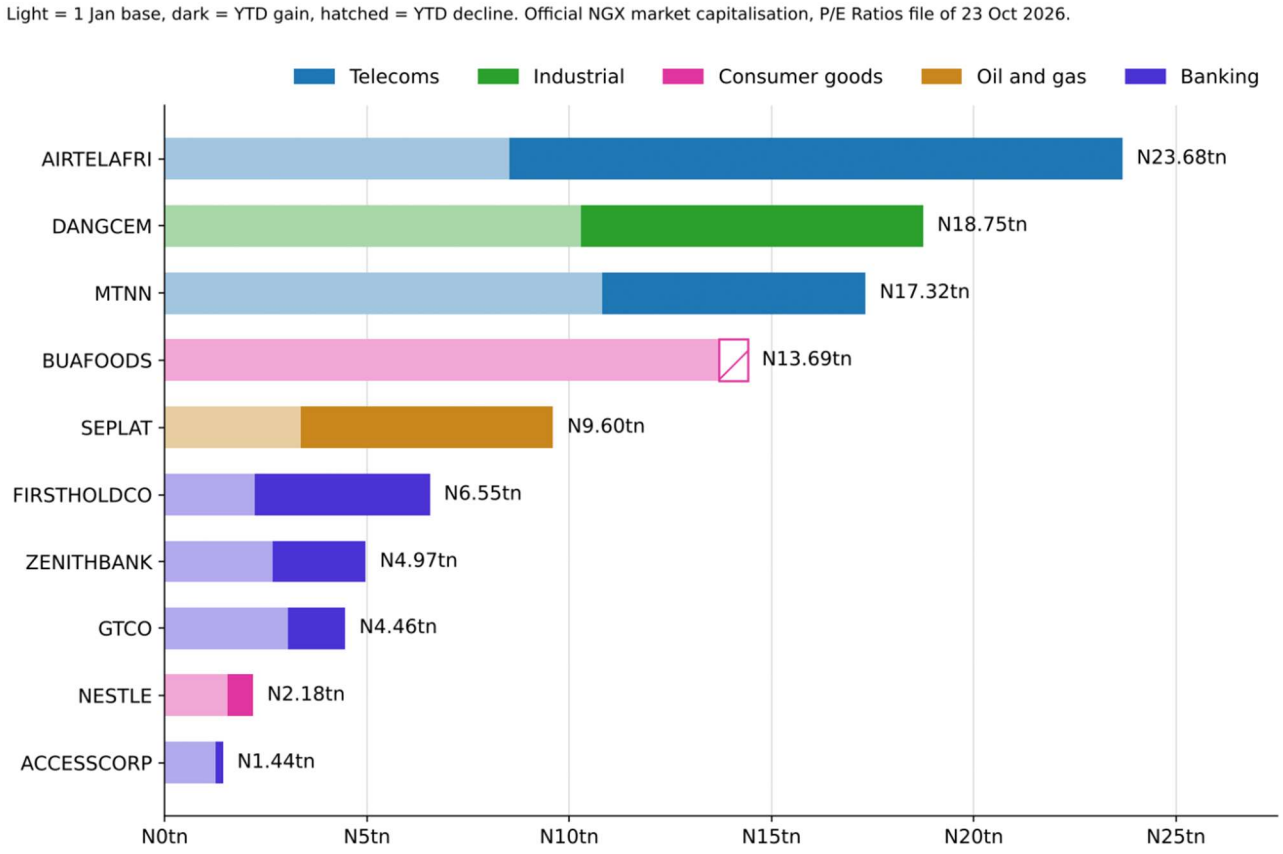
Ticker	Company	Close (₦)	Prev Close	WoW %	Mkt Cap (₦tn)	YTD %	P/E	Analyst Note
MTNN	MTN Nigeria	825.00	825.00	0.00%	17.32	+61%	81,073.11	NGX file prints 81,073.1x. Not meaningful; treated as an outlier and excluded from averages under the >100x rule.
GTCO	GTCO	122.00	124.80	-2.24%	4.46	+46%	17.18	17.2x trailing. Premium to Zenith (9.1x) and Access (9.4x) within the bank group.
DANGCEM	Dangote Cement	1,111.00	1,066.70	+4.15%	18.75	+82%	1,766.54	1,766.5x on the NGX file. Recurring outlier above 1,000x, excluded under the >100x rule. Q3 board meeting on 27 Oct.
ACCESSCORP	Access Holdings	26.50	28.50	-7.02%	1.44	+15%	9.42	9.4x trailing. Second cheapest on the watch list after Zenith.
BUAFOODS	BUA Foods	760.60	760.60	0.00%	13.69	-5%		No P/E printed in the NGX file of 23 Oct. Q3 board meeting on 29 Oct.
AIRTELAFRI	Airtel Africa	6,300.00	6,300.00	0.00%	23.68	+178%		No P/E printed in the NGX file of 23 Oct. Largest listed equity by market value.
ZENITHBANK	Zenith Bank	120.90	126.00	-4.05%	4.97	+87%	9.09	9.1x trailing. Cheapest multiple on the watch list.
FIRSTHOLDCO	First HoldCo (FBN)	144.10	138.00	+4.42%	6.55	+195%	61.89	61.9x trailing, before 9M PAT growth of 65.11% enters trailing EPS. Elevated against bank peers UBA (10.1x) and Zenith (9.1x).
NESTLE	Nestlé Nigeria	2,750.00	2,750.00	0.00%	2.18	+40%	66.58	66.6x trailing. Below Food Products Diversified peer Cadbury (93.7x).
SEPLAT	Seplat Energy	16,000.10	16,000.10	0.00%	9.60	+185%	75.22	75.2x trailing. Well above Oando (13.2x).

Closes are Friday 23 Oct against Friday 16 Oct. Market capitalisation and P/E are from the NGX Current Equity P/E Ratios file of 23 Oct 2026. Zenith's close is from United Capital's 23 Oct daily market report; Access's close is implied from its official capitalisation at an unchanged share count. YTD returns are rounded and, for Zenith, Access and First HoldCo, recalculated to 23 Oct closes from the 1 Jan reference prices used in prior issues.

Market Movers Commentary

- Large caps outperformed on a full week basis. NGX 30 ended ▼0.01% WoW against ▼0.13% for the ASI and ▼0.77% for the Main Board Index, while the NGX Premium Index rose ▲0.80%. Friday's ▲10.00% limit moves left Dangote Cement ▲4.15% at ₦1,111.00 and First HoldCo ▲4.42% at ₦144.10 for the week. Banks stayed soft, with Access ▼7.02% and Zenith ▼4.05%, leaving Zenith at 9.09x trailing, the cheapest on the list, against 61.89x for First HoldCo.

NGX Large Cap: Official Market Capitalisation, YTD Performance and Sector



Market Movers Commentary

Airtel Africa held ₦23.68tn, unchanged at ₦6,300.00 for a ninth consecutive week, and remains the most capitalised stock on the NGX. Its lead over second place narrowed to ₦4.93tn from ₦5.68tn. Dangote Cement rose ▲4.15% to ₦1,111.00 for ₦18.75tn, and MTN Nigeria was unchanged at ₦17.32tn, which widened the gap between them to ₦1.43tn from ₦0.68tn. Capitalisations are the official NGX figures in the Current Equity P/E Ratios file of 23 Oct 2026, and weekly changes compare them with the 16 Oct file.

- **Telecoms (blue)**: Airtel Africa ₦23.68tn at ₦6,300.00 (▲178% YTD), unchanged on the week. MTN Nigeria ₦17.32tn at ₦825.00, unchanged WoW (▲61% YTD).
- **Industrial (green)**: Dangote Cement ₦18.75tn at ₦1,111.00 (▲4.15% WoW, ▲82% YTD), after a ▲10.00% limit move on Friday. Industrial Goods Index ▲1.95%.
- **Consumer goods (pink)**: BUA Foods ₦13.69tn at ₦760.60, unchanged for a tenth week and still the only large cap negative YTD at ▼5%. Nestlé ₦2.18tn at ₦2,750.00 (flat WoW, ▲40% YTD, 66.6x). Consumer Goods Index ▼0.55%.
- **Oil and gas (amber)**: Seplat ₦9.60tn, flat at ₦16,000.10 (▲185% YTD, 75.2x). Oil & Gas Index ▼2.55%, led lower by Aradel.
- **Banking (purple)**: Index ▼0.67%.
  - First HoldCo ₦6.55tn at ₦144.10 (▲4.42% WoW, ▲195% YTD, 61.9x). Zenith ₦4.97tn at ₦120.90 (▼4.05%, 9.1x).
  - GTCO ₦4.46tn at ₦122.00 (▼2.24%, 17.2x).
  - Access ₦1.44tn at ₦26.50 (▼7.02%, 9.4x).

Large caps outperformed the market, reversing last week's pattern. Two of the ten rose, five were flat and three fell, against no risers and five decliners a week ago. Aggregate official capitalisation across the ten rose ₦0.60tn, or ▲0.59% WoW, to ₦102.63tn, against a ₦206bn fall for the whole market and ▼0.13% for the ASI. The remaining listed equities therefore lost approximately ₦0.81tn in aggregate, on the same official file basis.

Aradel's ▼6.33% to ₦1,405.00 accounts for about half of that loss: its official capitalisation fell ₦0.42tn to ₦6.10tn. Within the group, Dangote Cement's ₦0.75tn gain exceeded the group's entire net rise. The four banks lost ₦0.14tn net, as First HoldCo's ₦0.27tn gain offset most of the ₦0.42tn lost across Zenith, GTCO and Access.

Valuation dispersion widened: First HoldCo at 61.9x against Zenith at 9.1x, now 6.8 times apart, up from 6.3 times.

Airtel Africa and Seplat again show the gap between index weight and investable liquidity. They carry ₦23.68tn and ₦9.60tn of capitalisation with no price change, while Zenith led Monday to Thursday volume at 116.85m shares and ranks among NGX's three most traded stocks for the full week.

SECTION 6 | NIGERIA — EARNINGS & CORPORATE ACTIONS

Earnings Releases

Company	Period	Reported revenue / income (₦bn)	PAT (₦bn)	EPS (₦)	Analyst Comment
First HoldCo Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	2,870.00	744.45	16.45	Gross earnings ₦2.87tn, up 8.79% from ₦2.64tn. PBT ₦911.24bn, up 60.84% from ₦566.54bn; Q3 PBT ₦257.71bn, up 22.49%. PAT ₦744.45bn, up 65.11% from ₦450.87bn. EPS ₦16.45 vs ₦10.65. Net interest income ₦1.26tn, down 16.02%, offset by fees, trading gains and lower impairments. Total assets ₦32.20tn; deposits ₦22.91tn. No dividend stated. Shares hit the ₦144.10 limit up on 23 Oct. Reported income is gross earnings.
Stanbic IBTC Holdings Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	817.77	370.36	23.03	Gross earnings ₦817.77bn, up 24.82%. PBT ₦531.88bn, up 35.05% from ₦393.84bn; PAT ₦370.36bn, up 33.00%. EPS ₦23.03 vs ₦17.31. Net interest income ₦379.79bn, down 14.93%; non interest revenue ₦437.99bn, now 53.56% of income. Total assets ₦9.60tn; customer deposits ₦4.57tn. Scrip reference price ₦159.86 set for the ₦4.50 interim (see Corporate Events). Share price ₦160.00 on 23 Oct. Reported income is gross earnings.
Unilever Nigeria Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	184.00	26.40	Not disclosed	Revenue ₦184.0bn, up 18% from ₦155.4bn. Gross margin 46.4% vs 41.2%; operating profit ₦38.5bn, up 27%. Net profit ₦26.4bn, up 20% from ₦21.9bn. PBT and EPS not stated in the coverage reviewed. Interim dividend ₦2.00 per share (₦11.5bn), register closes 30 Oct. Reported income is revenue.
Nigerian Exchange Group Plc (NGX Group)	9M 2026 (unaudited)	27.26	14.69	Not disclosed	Revenue ₦27.26bn, up 79.79%; total income ₦29.57bn, up 64.78%. PBT ₦20.58bn, up 83.29% from ₦11.23bn. PAT ₦14.69bn, up 86.44% from ₦7.88bn. Results followed a 10.29% weekly fall in the stock to ₦152.50, which remains up 117.86% YTD. EPS not stated in the coverage reviewed. Reported income is revenue.
Guinness Nigeria Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	403.33	40.69	18.58	Revenue ₦403.33bn, up 20.37% from ₦335.07bn; Q3 revenue ₦138.29bn, up 41.01%. PBT ₦61.65bn, up 55.34%. PAT ₦40.69bn, up 53.05% from ₦26.59bn. EPS ₦18.58 vs ₦12.14. Finance costs down 61.88% to ₦5.83bn. Third interim dividend of ₦7.00, taking 2026 interims to ₦16.00. Filed after market close on 21 Oct; share price ₦423.00. Reported income is revenue.
LASACO Assurance Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	23.81	1.25	Not disclosed	Insurance revenue ₦23.81bn, up 3.71%. PBT ₦1.60bn vs a loss of ₦4.72bn; PAT ₦1.25bn vs a loss of ₦4.81bn. Insurance service result ₦5.84bn vs a ₦2.44bn loss. Total assets ₦61.23bn, up 56.03%, after ₦18.10bn rights issue proceeds. Share price ₦1.90 on 20 Oct, down 22.5% YTD. Reported income is insurance revenue.
Africa Prudential Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	6.91	2.69	0.67	Net operating income ₦6.91bn, up 35.23%; interest income ₦5.85bn, up 46.05%. PBT ₦4.07bn, up 34.79%. PAT ₦2.69bn, up 30.83%. EPS 67 kobo vs 51 kobo. No dividend stated. Share price ₦10.20 on 23 Oct, down

					31.08% YTD. Reported income is net operating income.
Transcorp Hotels Plc	9M 2026 (unaudited)	69.46	15.54	1.52	Revenue ₦69.46bn, down 2.58% from ₦71.30bn. PBT ₦22.53bn, up 0.55%; PAT ₦15.54bn, up 4.85%. EPS 152 kobo vs 145 kobo. Q3 PBT ₦8.83bn, down 13.18% from ₦10.18bn. No dividend declared; ₦13.32bn paid in the period from prior declarations. Share price ₦290.50 on 16 Oct, up 76.49% YoY. Reported income is revenue.
Veritas Kapital Assurance Plc	FY 2025 (audited)	22.60	3.05	Not disclosed	Insurance revenue ₦22.60bn, down 3% from ₦23.33bn. PBT ₦3.16bn vs a loss of ₦1.49bn in 2024. PAT ₦3.05bn, up 86.4% from ₦1.63bn. No dividend; shareholders raised this at the 49th AGM. EPS not stated in coverage. Share price ₦1.08 on 14 Oct. Reported income is insurance revenue.
Dangote Petroleum Refinery & Petrochemicals FZE (unlisted, IPO in progress)	9M 2026 (unaudited)	$22.48bn	$4.73bn	Not disclosed	USD figures; not comparable with ₦ columns. Revenue $22.48bn vs $9.19bn. Net profit $4.73bn vs a $117.2m loss. EBITDA $5.52bn vs $627.6m. Operating cash flow $3.68bn; cash $6.69bn; net cash $650.8m vs net debt of $1.73bn a year earlier. Published 13 Oct, ahead of the extended IPO close on 27 Oct.
FTN Cocoa Processors Plc	FY 2025 (audited)	5.65	(0.27)	(0.07)	Revenue ₦5.65bn, up 310.5% from ₦1.38bn. Loss before and after tax ₦273.40m vs PBT loss of ₦10.62bn and PAT loss of ₦9.53bn in 2024. Loss per share ₦0.07 vs ₦2.44. Turnaround helped by a ₦1.84bn FX gain; still a gross loss of ₦685.92m. Restated previously overbooked export sales. Share price ₦7.55 on 12 Oct. Reported income is revenue.

Dividend Announcements

Company	Type	DPS (₦)	Qualification Date	Payment Date
Guinness Nigeria Plc	Interim (9M 2026)	7.00	30 Oct 2026	13 Nov 2026
Unilever Nigeria Plc	Interim (9M 2026)	2.00	30 Oct 2026	To be confirmed
Stanbic IBTC Holdings Plc	Interim (H1 2026), scrip option	4.50	15 Oct 2026	13 Nov 2026
Zenith Bank Plc	Interim (H1 2026)	1.50	23 Oct 2026	30 Oct 2026
PZ Cussons Nigeria	Final (FY26)	2.50	09 Oct 2026	30 Oct 2026

AGMs, Rights Issues & Other Corporate Events

Company / Body	Event Type	Event Date	Key Details
ABC Transport Plc	Capital raise (board approval)	21 Oct 2026	Board approved on 17 Oct a ₦6.5bn raise through a rights issue and a bond issue; notice dated 21 Oct. Subject to shareholder approval at the AGM; AGM date, split, pricing and use of proceeds not disclosed. The raise is about 4.4 times the ₦1.48bn of financing obligations at 30 Jun 2026. Non Executive Director Kabiru Yusuf resigned effective 30 Sep.
Stanbic IBTC Holdings Plc	Scrip dividend pricing	23 Oct 2026	Scrip reference price set at ₦159.86 per share for the ₦4.50 H1 2026 interim. Shareholders electing new shares must do so by 6 Nov; cash payment 13 Nov. Share price ₦160.00 on 23 Oct. Released alongside 9M 2026 results (see Earnings table).
LASACO Assurance Plc	Change in major shareholding	21 Oct 2026	Ibile Holdings (Lagos State) now holds 51.00% vs 45.93% at December 2025, per the 9M 2026 filing. Issued shares rose to 20.32bn from 11.08bn after the 5 for 6 rights issue at ₦2.00. Canon Properties rose to 36.21%. Free float fell to 12.78% from 21.52%, below the Main Board requirement; the company says it is working to comply.
PZ Cussons Nigeria Plc	AGM / dividend	28 Oct 2026	FY2026 AGM scheduled for 28 Oct 2026; proposed final dividend of ₦2.50 per share, first since 2022, qualification date 9 Oct and payment 30 Oct 2026.
Dangote Petroleum Refinery & Petrochemicals FZE	IPO offer extended	27 Oct 2026	SEC approved extending the offer close from 13 Oct to 27 Oct 2026 (notice to investors 12 Oct). Revised timetable: returns collated 3 Nov; basis of allotment to SEC 10 Nov; SEC no objection expected 17 Nov; allotment, refund and listing dates not given. Offer: 4.1bn shares at ₦525, about $1.6bn, minimum 10 shares. NGX Group CEO Temi Popoola told Reuters on 22 Oct the IPO could lift active investor numbers three to five times; no subscription figures have been published. Cross border: Kenya GDRs (about 729m, up to $300.4mn), with the minimum reported cut to 10 GDRs (KES 535); the Egyptian Exchange discussed a depositary receipt programme on 15 Oct (not finalised); Botswana about $500mn in DRs with Gaborone as venue; Ethiopia approved an offer to up to 100 qualified investors. 9M 2026 net profit $4.73bn released 13 Oct (see Earnings table).
Various issuers	Q3 2026 results calendar	20 Oct 2026	Dangote Cement moved its board meeting to 27 Oct from 29 Oct (notice to NGX 15 Oct); closed period since 1 Oct. MTN Nigeria board meeting 29 Oct. Released this week: Guinness (21 Oct), LASACO (21 Oct), Unilever (23 Oct), First HoldCo (23 Oct), Stanbic IBTC, NGX Group and Africa Prudential (reported 24 Oct). No 9M release had appeared as at 26 Oct from BUA Cement (meeting 20 Oct), Haldane McCall (23 Oct) or Meyer (26 Oct). Still to come: Julius Berger audit committee 27 Oct; Consolidated Hallmark Holdings 28 Oct; BUA Foods 29 Oct. FCMB Group extended its 9M deadline to 29 Dec (notice 26 Sep) pending an interim audit of the bank.
Airtel Africa Plc (Airtel Money)	Unconditional dealings (London)	14 Oct 2026	Admission and unconditional dealings began 14 Oct on the LSE under ticker AMC. Shares opened at 181.28p, about 7.5% below the 196p offer price, and recovered to about 186p, still below the offer. Valuation about £5.3bn (~$7bn), below the $8bn to $9bn range reported during preparation. 270m existing shares sold plus up to 27m under the over allotment; no new capital raised.
eTranzact International Plc	Change of control / board changes	13 Oct 2026	Trademarks Global Concepts Ltd acquired 5,168,921,170 shares (56.18%) from Access Bank Plc, Meristem Trustees (as trustee for Accelerex Holdings) and eTranzact Global Ltd. Resigned: Chuma Ajene, Benjamin Dabra, Afolabi Oladele (NEDs), Binta Max Gbinije and Maj Gen Emeka Onwuamaegbu (rtd) (INEDs). Appointed: Akin Akinfemiwa, Olatunde Akande, Doron Grupper (NEDs), Omobola Hollist and Mustapha Ajenifuja SAN (INEDs). CBN approved the appointments. The stock rose 42.98% WoW to ₦17.30.

SECTION 7 | NIGERIA — MACRO DASHBOARD

Currency & FX

Indicator	Latest Value	As-of Date	WoW Change	WoW %
USD/NGN (NAFEM Official)	1,361.84	23 Oct	29.58	+2.22%
GBP/NGN	1,821.39	23 Oct	55.22	+3.13%
EUR/NGN	1,524.31	23 Oct	28.96	+1.94%
Gold (USD/oz)	3,993.62	23 Oct	-174.83	-4.19%

Key Macroeconomic Indicators

Indicator	Latest Value	As-of Date	Prior Period	Change
USD/NGN Parallel Rate (Bureau)	1,375.00	23 Oct 2026	1,380.00	-0.36%
Nigeria CPI Inflation (YoY %)	14.63%	Sep 2026 (rel. 15 Oct)	15.39%	-76 bps
CBN Monetary Policy Rate (MPR %)	23.00%	Sep 2026 MPC	26.50%	-350 bps
Brent Crude (USD/bbl)	117.14	23 Oct 2026	109.86	+6.63%
Nigeria Bonny Light (USD/bbl)	~115.00	24 Oct 2026	117.92	n/c
FGN 10-Yr Bond Yield (%)	16.90%	22 Oct 2026	16.94%	-4 bps
Nigeria Foreign Reserves (USD bn)	55.16	22 Oct 2026	55.09	+0.13%
MPC / NBS Event This Week	CBN OMO auction: ₦2.63tn sold (22 Oct)			

Macro Commentary

- The naira weakened 2.2% WoW against the dollar, with the NFEM official rate closing at ₦1,361.84 on 23 Oct from ₦1,332.26, its weakest level since August. Pressure built late in the week. The rate moved about ₦28 on Thursday, and interbank turnover reached a record $1.01bn on Friday as the CBN stepped up dollar sales. The parallel market held near ₦1,375, so the official to parallel spread narrowed to ₦13.16 from about ₦48. GBP/NGN rose ▲3.13% to ₦1,821.39 and EUR/NGN ▲1.94% to ₦1,524.31.
- The MPR stands at 23.00% after the 350bps cut at the 21 and 22 Sep MPC, with no meeting this week. September headline inflation eased to 14.63% YoY from 15.39%, its third consecutive decline, with MoM inflation at 0.06%. The FGN 10 year yield slipped 4bps to 16.90%. The CBN leaned against excess liquidity, selling ₦2.63tn of OMO bills on 22 Oct against a ₦2.00tn offer. Stop rates were 17.14% on the 180 day bill and 17.63% on the 138 day bill, while banks held about ₦6tn at the deposit window.
- Brent rose ▲6.63% WoW to $117.14/bbl after Houthi strikes on Saudi energy infrastructure. Bonny Light traded near $115/bbl on 24 Oct; the prior week's $117.92 came from a different price source, so no weekly change is reported. Gross external reserves rose $0.07bn to $55.16bn on 22 Oct, close to an 18 year high, which gives the CBN room to keep intervening. Gold fell ▼4.19% to $3,993.62/oz.
- **Events to watch next week**: Dangote refinery IPO close (27 Oct); ₦800bn NTB auction and US FOMC decision (28 Oct); MTN Nigeria Q3 board meeting (29 Oct).

Valuation Metrics

Metric	Current (23 Oct 2026)	Prior Week (16 Oct 2026)	Change
NGX Main Board weighted contribution ratio (NGX published; see note)	41.47x	41.70x	-0.23
Covered Main Board cap weighted trailing P/E (Equinox recomputed)	29.17x †	29.24x †	-0.07
Covered Main Board cap weighted trailing P/E, excluding constituents above 100x	18.83x †	18.93x †	-0.10
Covered share of Main Board capitalisation	₦33.02tn of ₦93.70tn (35.2%)	₦33.10tn of ₦94.43tn (35.1%)	+0.2pp
Banking Sector avg P/E (Main, Premium and Non-Interest boards)	21.93x †	21.68x †	+0.25
Consumer Goods avg P/E (Main Board)	58.14x	59.09x	-0.95
Oil & Gas avg P/E (Main and Premium boards)	52.03x	52.39x	-0.36
Market Dividend Yield (avg), latest observation 14 Aug 2026	3.75% (carried forward from 14 Aug 2026)	3.75% (carried forward from 14 Aug 2026)	N/A

Source: NGX Current Equity P/E Ratios files of 23 Oct 2026 and 16 Oct 2026. Methodology note: the ratio NGX publishes as the Main Board Market Total (41.47 on 23 Oct 2026) is the sum, across constituents, of market capitalisation divided by total market capitalisation on all boards, multiplied by that constituent's P/E. On 23 Oct 2026 the implied denominator is approximately ₦164.86tn against a Main Board capitalisation of ₦93.70tn, and only ₦33.02tn of Main Board capitalisation carries a published P/E. The ₦164.86tn reconciles to the sum of every board in the file (Main ₦93.70tn, Premium ₦66.06tn, FGN bonds ₦3.70tn, mutual funds ₦0.64tn, Non-Interest ₦0.35tn, Growth ₦0.33tn, REITs ₦0.07tn), so the NGX denominator spans every board, not equities only. The published figure is therefore a coverage limited weighted contribution, not a cap weighted market P/E, and is retained here only for continuity with prior issues. Equinox recomputes a covered Main Board cap weighted trailing P/E as total covered capitalisation divided by total covered earnings, where earnings are derived as capitalisation divided by the published P/E. † Sterling Financial Holdings prints at 256.4x because NGX has not restated EPS for the 1 for 10 share reconstruction listed on 8 Oct; Equinox carries it at 25.6x (printed P/E divided by 10), consistent with prior weeks. On the P/E as printed the three figures marked † would be 29.65x, 18.70x and 21.46x. Coverage on 23 Oct 2026 is 78 of 125 Main Board lines, unchanged from 16 Oct; 27 of the 78 print above 100x on the adjusted basis, also unchanged. Sector figures are equal weighted averages of P/E across constituents reporting usable data, excluding any constituent above 100x. Banking covers 9 of 11 bank and bank holdco lines across the Main, Premium and Non-Interest boards, excluding Wema at 756.7x and Jaiz at 268.2x; the rise is led by First HoldCo at 61.9x from 59.3x, partly offset by Access at 9.4x from 10.1x, Zenith at 9.1x from 9.5x and GTCO at 17.2x from 17.6x. Consumer Goods covers 7 of 13 Main Board lines with a published P/E, the same count as on 16 Oct. Oil & Gas covers all 6 lines with a published P/E across the Main and Premium boards; the average includes Japaul Gold at 0.2x, without which it would be 62.4x. Aradel carries no published P/E, so its weekly move does not enter the average. Market Dividend Yield is unchanged from 14 Aug 2026 and is flagged as carried forward, not a fresh observation.

Foreign Portfolio Investment (FPI)

Metric	Current (Sep-26)	Prior (Aug-26)	Trend
FPI Buy Value (₦bn)	92.52	26.47	↑
FPI Sell Value (₦bn)	98.62	35.56	↑
FPI Buy/Sell Ratio	0.94	0.74	↑
FPI Net Flow (₦bn)	(6.10)	(9.09)	↑ (less negative)
FPI as % of Total Turnover	10.52%	4.89%	↑

Source: NGX Domestic & Foreign Portfolio Investment Reports for August and September 2026. FPI buy = foreign inflow (purchases), sell = foreign outflow (sales). Ratio and net flow computed by Equinox; net outflows shown in parentheses. September total transactions ₦1.8162tn (about $1.3664bn at ₦1,329.16/$), ▲43.06% MoM. Foreign transactions rose ▲208.14% MoM to ₦191.14bn (about $143.80mn), lifting the foreign share to 10.52%, the highest since June (10.90%). 2026 YTD foreign share 10.26% vs 21.56% in 2025 YTD.

Valuation Commentary

- Zenith trades at 9.1x and Access at 9.4x, against GTCO at 17.2x and First HoldCo at 61.9x; First HoldCo's 65% rise in 9M PAT has yet to enter its trailing earnings. Consumer Goods at 58.1x and Oil & Gas at 52.0x price in growth, led by Seplat at 75.2x and Nestlé at 66.6x. Three large caps lack a usable multiple:
  - Dangote Cement prints 1,766.5x on the NGX file, which is not a usable multiple and is excluded under the >100x rule.
  - MTN prints 81,073x, which is not meaningful and is excluded on the same basis.
  - BUA Foods carries no published P/E in the 23 Oct file.
- **Foreign participation recovered in September**. FPI buys rose to ₦92.52bn and sells to ₦98.62bn, lifting the buy/sell ratio to 0.94 and the foreign share of turnover to 10.52% from 4.89%. The ₦6.10bn net outflow, narrower than August's ₦9.09bn, is consistent with renewed participation rather than sustained net buying.

SECTION 9 | INVESTMENT THEME

THEME: Stock selection amid narrowing breadth and sector dispersion

OBSERVATION	The NGX ASI closed the week at 247,222.27, down 0.13% WoW and 1.59% MTD from September's 251,211.67 close, though still up 58.87% YTD. Participation is narrowing beneath a stable headline. On NGX's weekly count, 55 stocks declined against 20 advancers (A/D 0.36x from 1.67x), and the ten watch list stocks added ₦0.60tn while the rest of the market lost about ₦0.81tn. NGX 30 was flat at -0.01% against -0.77% for the Main Board Index.
DRIVER	Domestic investors account for most trading. Foreign investors accounted for only 10.26% of 9M 2026 turnover and were net sellers of ₦281.26bn, including a further ₦6.10bn net outflow in September despite a rebound in foreign trading to 10.52% of turnover. Fixed income competes for domestic money: the 364 day NTB stopped at 15.90% on 14 Oct, against a market dividend yield of 3.75%, and the CBN sold ₦2.63tn of OMO bills on 22 Oct at 17.14% (180 day) and 17.63% (138 day). The NFEM rate weakened 2.2% WoW to ₦1,361.84 despite record $1.01bn turnover and increased CBN dollar sales.
IMPLICATION	The current data fit our consolidation scenario more closely than a broad continuation of the rally. Stock selection should favour reported earnings that can re-rate trailing multiples, subject to earnings quality: • First HoldCo: 9M PAT up 65.11%, although net interest income fell 16.02%. • Stanbic IBTC: 9M PAT up 33.00%. • Zenith: still at 9.1x trailing. Investors may prefer stock selection over index exposure, which is concentrated: Dangote Cement's 10.00% Friday move left it with a ₦0.75tn weekly gain, more than the watch list's ₦0.60tn net rise. For dollar-based investors, the naira's 2.2% weekly depreciation compounded the ASI's 0.13% local decline.
RISK	Three outcomes would invalidate this view: • The ₦800bn NTB auction on 28 Oct clears below the 14 Oct 15.90% stop rate with full allotment. • The naira stabilises near ₦1,340 with the parallel spread holding below ₦20. • Foreign net flows turn positive in October, particularly in FTSE-eligible names.

SECTION 10 | OUTLOOK — SECTORAL VIEWS & EVENTS TO WATCH

Sectoral Outlook — Coming Week

Sector	View	Conviction	Rationale
Banking	OW	M	Selective overweight. Reported earnings are strong, with 9M PAT up 65.11% at First HoldCo and 33.00% at Stanbic IBTC, while Zenith (9.1x) and Access (9.4x) trade well below the 21.9x sector average after the index fell 7.25% MTD. Net interest income fell at First HoldCo (-16.02%) and Stanbic (-14.93%), and First HoldCo trades at 61.9x, so the view favours lower multiple banks rather than the whole sector.
Consumer Goods	N	M	Guinness 9M PAT rose 53.05%, helped by a 61.88% fall in finance costs, and Unilever's gross margin widened to 46.4% from 41.2%. The 58.1x sector P/E and a weaker naira at ₦1,361.84 limit upside for an index up only 0.99% YTD.
Oil & Gas	N	L	Brent at $117.14 (+6.63% WoW) may support sector cash flows, but higher crude prices do not pass uniformly to listed earnings: the index fell 2.55% in a week when Aradel dropped 6.33%, after a 126.04% YTD run. Seplat trades at 75.2x and Aradel carries no published P/E.
Industrial Goods	N	M	The only gaining sector (+1.95% WoW, +87.56% YTD), led by Dangote Cement's 10.00% Friday move, so the signal is company specific rather than sector wide. Dangote Cement's 1,766.5x printed P/E is not a usable anchor, which makes its 27 Oct Q3 results the next test.
Insurance	UW	M	The index is down 2.79% WoW and 11.76% YTD, with recapitalisation diluting existing holders: Guinea Insurance's ₦1.45 placement and LASACO's rights issue, which cut its free float to 12.78%.
Telco (MTN/Airtel)	N	L	Airtel Africa (₦23.68tn) has been unchanged at ₦6,300 for nine weeks and MTN's 81,073x P/E is not meaningful, leaving MTN's Q3 results after its 29 Oct board meeting as the main near term catalyst.

OW = Overweight (expect outperformance) · N = Neutral · UW = Underweight · H/M/L = High/Medium/Low conviction, reflecting the strength of the principal driver against the valuation or risk constraint; each rationale names the condition that would change the view.

▲ BULLISH FACTORS

- Disinflation supports easing. September CPI fell to 14.63% from 15.39% after the 350bps MPR cut to 23.00%, leaving an ex post real policy rate of about 8.4pp. That creates room for a further cut at the 23 and 24 Nov MPC, although the decision will depend on October CPI and the naira.
- 9M earnings are strong. PBT rose 60.84% at First HoldCo, 35.05% at Stanbic IBTC, 55.34% at Guinness and 83.29% at NGX Group, which could support re-rating of trailing multiples if sustained.
- External buffers and foreign participation are improving. Reserves reached $55.16bn on 22 Oct, close to an 18 year high, and the foreign share of

▼ BEARISH RISKS

- The naira is under renewed pressure. The NFEM rate weakened 2.2% WoW to ₦1,361.84 despite record $1.01bn turnover and increased CBN dollar sales, reducing dollar returns.
- Breadth is narrowing. 55 stocks declined against 20 advancers, and the ten watch list stocks added ₦0.60tn while the rest of the market lost about ₦0.81tn, leaving the index dependent on a few heavyweights.
- Fixed income is competing for domestic money. The 364 day NTB yields 15.90% and OMO bills cleared at 17.14% (180 day) and 17.63% (138

turnover rebounded to 10.52% in September, with the net outflow narrowing to ₦6.10bn from ₦9.09bn.	day), against a 3.75% dividend yield, while foreigners remain 9M net sellers of ₦281.26bn.

Events to Watch — Next Week

Date	Event Type	Details & Why It Matters
27 Oct 2026	Dangote refinery IPO closes; Dangote Cement Q3 board meeting	The offer close ends the subscription period; allotment and refunds follow the SEC timetable, with the basis of allotment due 10 Nov, so any return of funds to equities depends on that timing and subscriber behaviour. Dangote Cement (₦18.75tn) is the largest single index swing factor.
28 Oct 2026	₦800bn NTB auction; US FOMC decision	A stop rate above the 14 Oct 15.90% would strengthen the pull of fixed income on domestic money, and a hawkish Fed could add pressure on the naira.
29 Oct 2026	MTN Nigeria and BUA Foods Q3 board meetings	These are the first earnings read on ₦31tn of combined capitalisation; results that change expectations could move telco and consumer sentiment.

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